PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Dropped Consonants

Even native English speakers often simplify these complex blends in running speech by dropping one of the sounds, typically the middle consonant of the three. Below are some common examples of when North American English speakers reduce longer, more complex consonant blends. Again, look at the middle consonant of 3-consonant blends and see how they have dropped altogether!

/skt/turns to /st/:

risked	turns to “rist”
asked	turns to “ast”
basked	turns to “bast”
masked	turns to “mast”
tasked	turns to “tast”

/kts/turns to /ks/:

aspects	turns to “aspecs”
acts	turns to “aks”
ducts	turns to “duks”
facts	turns to “faks”
tracts	turns to “traks”
elects	turns to “uhleks”
evicts	turns to “uhviks”
ejects	turns to “uhjeks”
affects	turns to “uhfeks”
infects	turns to “infeks”
objects	turns to “uhbjeks”
impacts	turns to “impaks”
insects	turns to “inseks”

PROactive PRONUNCIATION

/ndz/ turns to /nz/:

diamonds	turns to “diamonz”
minds	turns to “minz”
finds	turns to “finz”
kinds	turns to “kinz”
bends	turns to “benz”
bands	turns to “banz”
hands	turns to “hanz”
lands	turns to “lanz”
stands	turns to “stanz”
wounds	turns to “wounz”
friends	turns to “frienz”

/mpt/ turns to /mt/:

prompt	turns to “promt”
tempt	turns to “temt”
unkempt	turns to “unkemt”
exempt	turns to “exemt”
attempt	turns to “attemt”
preempt	turns to “preemt”
contempt	turns to “contemt”
camped	turns to “camt”

/lfθ/turns to /lθ/:

twelfth	turns to “twelth”